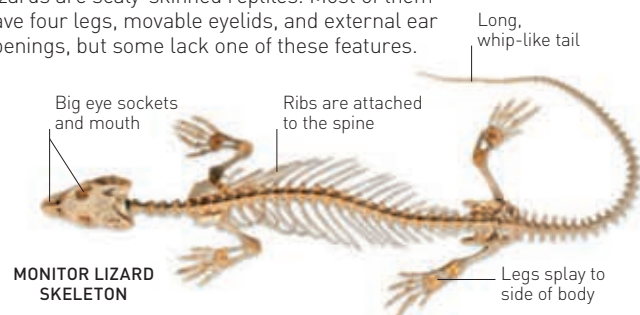


Lizards

With more than 5,500 species, lizards are the largest group of reptiles on Earth. They are cold-blooded animals that live in every continent except Antarctica. Lizards are useful predators of insect pests.

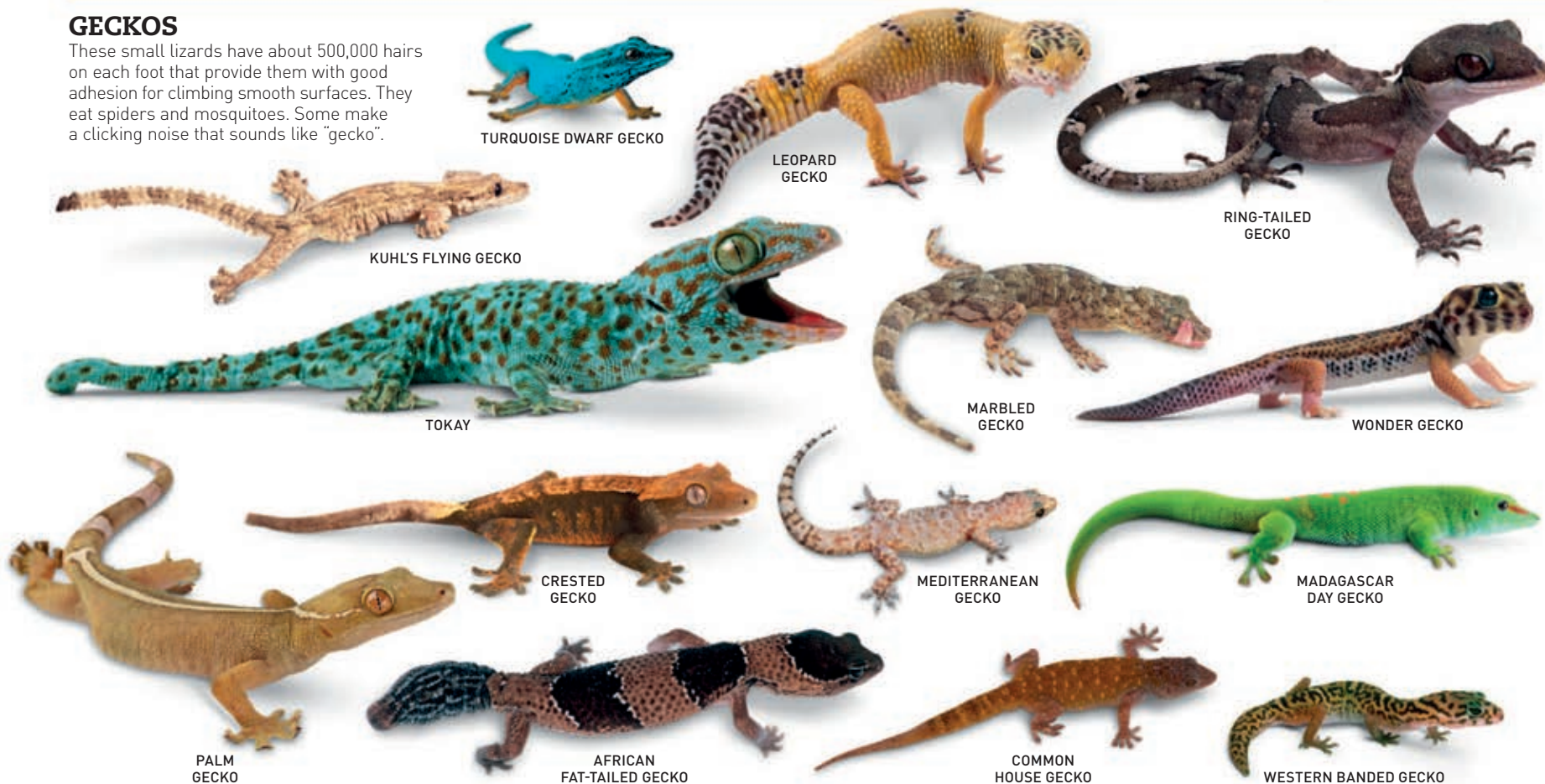
ANATOMY

Lizards are scaly-skinned reptiles. Most of them have four legs, movable eyelids, and external ear openings, but some lack one of these features.



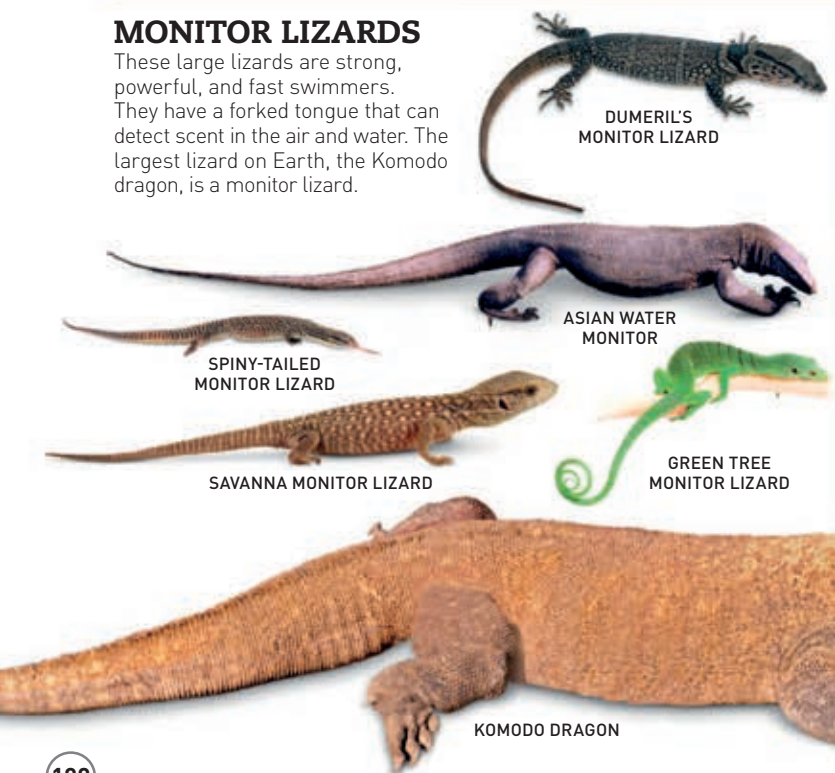
GECKOS

These small lizards have about 500,000 hairs on each foot that provide them with good adhesion for climbing smooth surfaces. They eat spiders and mosquitoes. Some make a clicking noise that sounds like "gecko".



MONITOR LIZARDS

These large lizards are strong, powerful, and fast swimmers. They have a forked tongue that can detect scent in the air and water. The largest lizard on Earth, the Komodo dragon, is a monitor lizard.



IGUANAS

Iguanas live in the tropical rainforests and deserts of the Americas, Fiji, and Madagascar. They can use their long tails like a whip for defence. The Marine Iguana is the only lizard that finds food in the sea, where it eats seaweed.

